

SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman	Date:	
High Risk Construction Work:	LOADER IN THE QUARRY ENVIRONMENT – SAFE OPERATION	Project:	
SWMS prepared Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group -Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
<u>John Guy</u> Name	<u>Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd</u> Position	<u>0408 449 023</u> 	 Signature
			<u>31/08/2025 – V12.0</u> Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training	To prevent injuries or illness to workers	1	1. Machinery operators will have the necessary current licence for the equipment they will operate. 2. All persons will have a current construction induction card.	Supervisor All	2
Pre Start Check	Unsafe working conditions. Potential for accident	1	1. Pre start checklist forms filled out & defects documented, supervisor notified. 2. Ensure windows/ mirrors are clean. 3. Ensure all controls are in neutral or park. 4. ensure all gear in the cabin is correctly stored 5. Adjust the seat and use the seat belt.	Operator	2
Starting checks	Unsafe working conditions Increased likelihood of accident during operation	1	1. The operator must be seated and in full control of the machine when starting. 2. Check the operation of all of the controls and gauges. 3. Listen and watch for defects. 4. Ensure all grounded attachments are safely retracted 5. Check safety locking pins in quick hitch are locked for buckets or attachments. 6. Test brakes & hand brake. 7. Test lights, horn and backup alarm 8. Test steering, limiting devices and all equipment controls.	Operator	2
General Safety rules when operating a loader	Striking personnel and plant	1	1. Reflective safety vests or clothing to be worn at all times. 2. Where possible minimise plant & personnel in work areas. 3. Separate trafficable areas. 4. Install give way and stop signs where necessary. 5. Loader to have operational flashing light and reversing beeper.	Supervisor All Supervisor Supervisor Operators	2
	Exposure to noise	2	1. Suppress noise using mufflers. 2. Ear protection must be worn by personnel working near noisy equipment.	Workshop All	3

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Struck by moving vehicle or objects, driving over objects on the ground that may flick up and strike another object, worker or the machine itself. Steel re-enforcement that may protrude outside the width of the bucket	1	- Do not carry passengers. - Always keep machine under control. - Carry the bucket as close to the ground as possible and racked back to allow greater stability & vision. - Travel at a safe speed for the operation being undertaken. - Be aware of what objects on the travel path that may flick up or be dislodged whilst traveling over them. Be aware of objects that may protrude outside the width of the bucket. - Ensure that no persons are within range of being struck by protruding objects.	Operator	2
	Uncontrolled slippage	1	- Do not travel across the slope on a steep incline. - Assess ground surface conditions eg; wet ground conditions, steep slope.	Operator	2
Loader Operation	Various including possible death if risk controls not followed.	1	- Before loading, check the cubic capacity of the bucket and the type of material to be handled to ensure overloading does not occur. - At all times carry a loaded bucket as close to the ground as possible, to just clear ground obstructions. Do not raise the bucket to unloading height until reaching the dumping point. The dangers of a high bucket are instability, obstructed vision and the possibility of striking overhead obstructions. - When travelling on sloping surfaces with a loaded bucket, always keep the bucket facing uphill and never travel sideways on a steep incline. If necessary, prepare the sloping surface by cut and fill before taking loads up or down. - Never travel in reverse before looking behind to check for persons or obstructions in your intended path. - Major factors in accidents during truck loading operations include truck position, driver location and traffic flow. Loader operators should move cautiously, especially in congested areas. - The loader operator and the truck driver should agree where the driver will stay when the truck is being loaded; either in the cab, or away from both loader and truck – never on the truck body. - Persons are not to ride in the bucket.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			8. To avoid cave-in, never work close to loose edges. Remember the loaded machine is extremely heavy when back filling deep trenches, work at 90 degrees to its edge. 9. Buckets should always be grounded when the operator leaves the cab. A bucket left elevated for any reason should be securely blocked. 10. Equipment left unattended should be locked or made inoperable so that any unauthorised person, particularly a child, cannot start the engine.		
Road travel	Tyre puncture Struck by moving parts Steering / brake failure	1	1. Ensure the tyres are clear of mud & rocks. 2. Ensure the hinged clip between the two brake pedals is locked into position (where applicable). 3. Raise the bucket to a safe traveling height (but also keep vision clear). 4. Apply park brake if brake failure occurs. 5. Apply brake and stop if steering failure.	Operator	2
Loader shut down	Personnel struck by rolling plant.	1	1. Access parking area as to site vision for other works in the area. 2. Park on firm, level ground where possible. 3. Park the machine up and down the slope when parking on a grade. 4. Park in a non-operating area. 5. Park away from deep excavations and trenches. 6. Place the transmission in neutral or park position. 7. Apply the park brake or hand brake. 8. Lower the bucket to the ground with the front cutting edge flat on the ground. 9. Lower other attachments(rippers) to the ground. 10. Idle the engine for gradual cooling before turning it off. 11. Turn the steering wheel back and forward and cycle the hydraulic controls to dissipate residual pressure in the hydraulic system before leaving the machine. 12. Remove the ignition key and secure the machine.	Operator	2

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg. Regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 5. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refuelling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment

All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:

Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.

All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card						
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management			
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training			

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)

Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022

Codes of Practice

Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2019
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2019	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2019	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2019
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2019	Safe Design of Structures - 2019

Plant & Equipment for this activity

- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site
- Daily maintenance & service checks.
- Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out.
- Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.

List of plant for this Activity

Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.